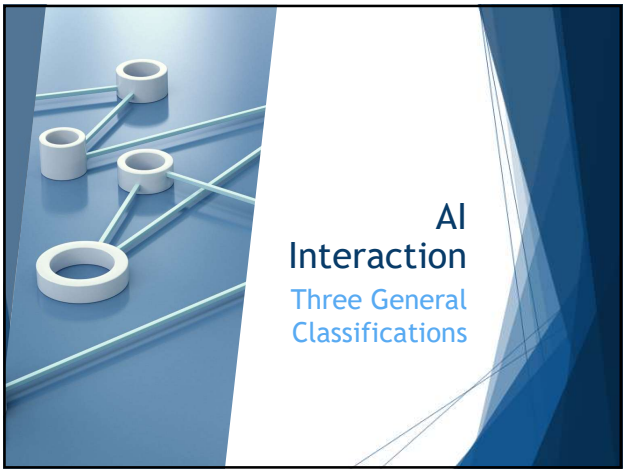
AI Classification

"A Practical Use"

1



AI Interaction

Three General Classifications

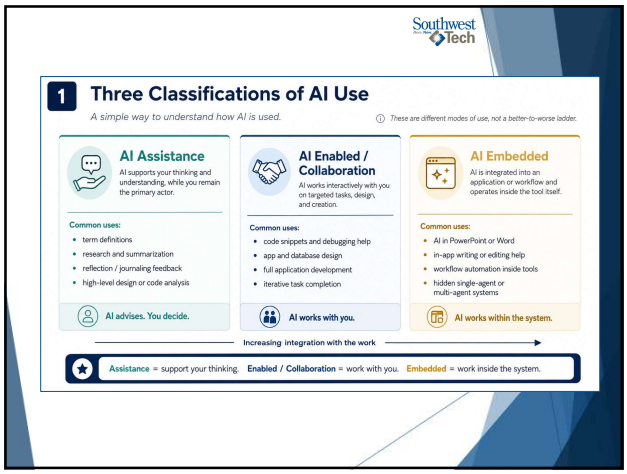
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Three "Main" Classifications of AI Use

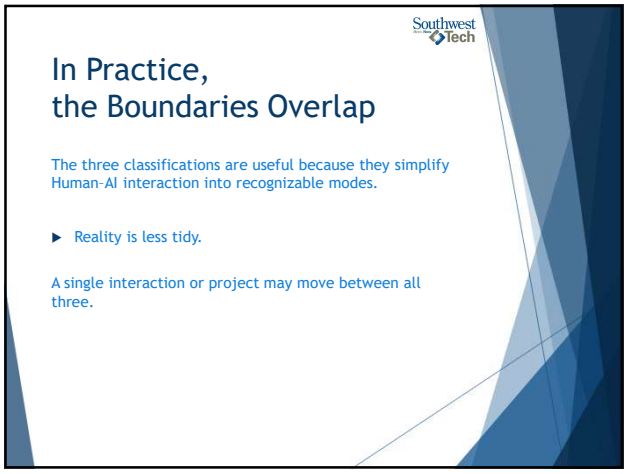
A useful shorthand is:

- **AI Assistance** — *AI supports your thinking.*
- **AI Enabled / Collaboration** — *AI works with you.*
- **AI Embedded — Three Classifications of AI Use**

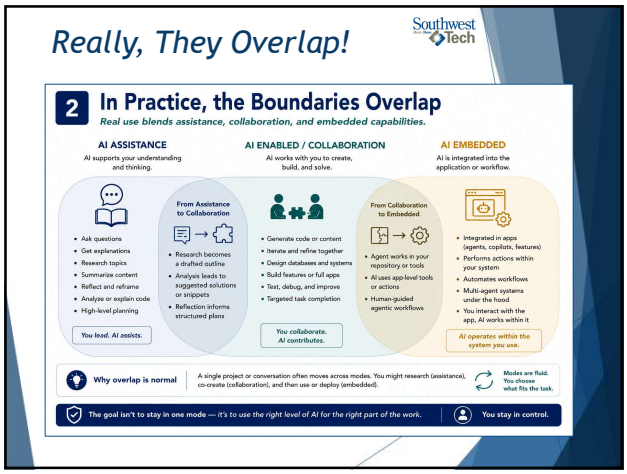
3


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Three Classifications of AI Use
A simple way to understand how AI is used.
These are different modes of use, not a better-to-worse ladder.
AI Assistance
AI supports your thinking and understanding, while you remain the primary actor.
Common uses:
term definitions
research and summarization
reflection / journaling feedback
high-level design or code analysis
AI advises. You decide.
AI Enabled / Collaboration
AI works interactively with you on targeted tasks, design, and creation.
Common uses:
code snippets and debugging help
app and database design
full application development
iterative task completion
AI works with you.
AI Embedded
AI is integrated into an application or workflow and operates inside the tool itself.
Common uses:
AI in PowerPoint or Word
in-app writing or editing help
workflow automation inside tools
hidden single-agent or multi-agent systems
AI works within the system.
Increasing integration with the work
Assistance = support your thinking. Enabled / Collaboration = work with you. Embedded = work inside the system.

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In Practice,
the Boundaries Overlap
The three classifications are useful because they simplify Human-AI interaction into recognizable modes.
Reality is less tidy.
A single interaction or project may move between all three.

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Really, They Overlap!
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In Practice, the Boundaries Overlap
Real use blends assistance, collaboration, and embedded capabilities.
AI ASSISTANCE
AI supports your understanding and thinking.
AI ENABLED / COLLABORATION
AI works with you to create, build, and solve.
AI EMBEDDED
AI is integrated into the application or workflow.
Ask questions
Get explanations
Research topics
Summarize content
Reflect and reframe
Analyze or explain code
High-level planning
You lead. AI assists.
From Assistance to Collaboration
Research becomes a drafted outline
Analysis leads to suggested solutions or snippets
Reflection informs structured plans
Generate code or content
Iterate and refine together
Design databases and systems
Build features or full apps
Test, debug, and improve
Targeted task completion
You collaborate. AI contributes.
From Collaboration to Embedded
Agent works in your repository or tools
AI uses app-level tools or actions
Human-guided agentic workflows
Integrated in apps (agents, copilots, features)
Performs actions within your system
Automates workflows
Multi-agent systems under the hood
You interact with the app, AI works within it
AI operates within the system you use.
Why overlap is normal
A single project or conversation often moves across modes. You might research (assistance), co-create (collaboration), and then use or deploy (embedded).
Modes are fluid. You choose what fits the task.
The goal isn't to stay in one mode — it's to use the right level of AI for the right part of the work.
You stay in control.

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A "Fourth" Classification!

AI Creation/Development

- Creating LLM's (Large Language Models)
- Creating CAG's & RAG's and Other types

This requires more in depth knowledge of:

- Algorithmic processing
- Neural Networks
- Types of AI models:
  - Descriptive/Analytical
  - Predictive
  - Generative
- Model Training and extensive Testing methodologies
- Data Analytics/Science

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Agency & Interaction

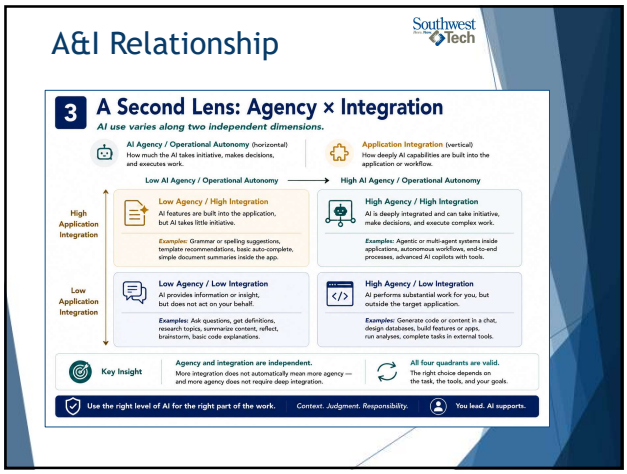
The overlap becomes easier to understand when the three classifications are examined using two independent dimensions.

- The first is ***AI Agency / Operational Autonomy***
- The second is ***Application Integration***.

These dimensions explain why two AI systems can belong to the same broad classification while behaving very differently.

The two dimensions create four useful regions…

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A&I Relationship
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A Second Lens: Agency × Integration
AI use varies along two independent dimensions.
AI Agency / Operational Autonomy (horizontal)
How much the AI takes initiative, makes decisions, and executes work.
Application Integration (vertical)
How deeply AI capabilities are built into the application or workflow.
Low AI Agency / Operational Autonomy
High AI Agency / Operational Autonomy
High Application Integration
Low Application Integration
Low Agency / High Integration
AI features are built into the application, but AI takes little initiative.
Examples: Grammar or spelling suggestions, template recommendations, basic auto-complete, simple document summaries inside the app.
High Agency / High Integration
AI is deeply integrated and can take initiative, make decisions, and execute complex work.
Examples: Agentic or multi-agent systems inside applications, autonomous workflows, end-to-end processes, advanced AI copilots with tools.
Low Agency / Low Integration
AI provides information or insight, but does not act on your behalf.
Examples: Ask questions, get definitions, research topics, summarize content, reflect, brainstorm, basic code explanations.
High Agency / Low Integration
AI performs substantial work for you, but outside the target application.
Examples: Generate code or content in a chat, design databases, build features or apps, run analyses, complete tasks in external tools.
Key Insight
Agency and integration are independent.
More integration does not automatically mean more agency — and more agency does not require deep integration.
All four quadrants are valid.
The right choice depends on the task, the tools, and your goals.
Use the right level of AI for the right part of the work.
Context. Judgment. Responsibility.
You lead. AI supports.

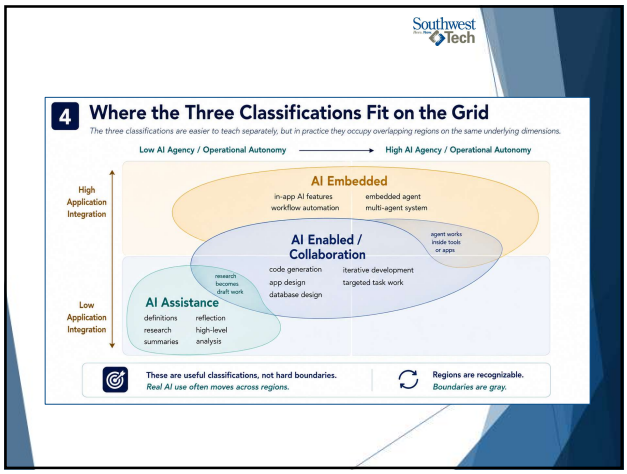
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AI Interaction
Classification
"combined with"
Agency &
Interaction

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Where the Three Classifications Fit
The three classifications are therefore not isolated boxes.
They occupy recognizable but overlapping regions across the Agency × Integration dimensions.

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Where the Three Classifications Fit on the Grid
The three classifications are easier to teach separately, but in practice they occupy overlapping regions on the same underlying dimensions.
Low AI Agency / Operational Autonomy
High AI Agency / Operational Autonomy
High Application Integration
Low Application Integration
AI Embedded
in-app AI features
workflow automation
embedded agent
multi-agent system
AI Enabled / Collaboration
agent works inside tools or apps
code generation
app design
database design
iterative development
targeted task work
research becomes draft work
AI Assistance
definitions
research
summaries
reflection
high-level
analysis
These are useful classifications, not hard boundaries.
Real AI use often moves across regions.
Regions are recognizable.
Boundaries are gray.

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Conclusion
Artificial intelligence is not used in only one way.
Sometimes AI explains.
Sometimes it collaborates.
Sometimes it operates within the systems people use.
And increasingly, a single workflow may move among all three.
The three classifications provide an accessible starting point:
Assistance → Collaboration → Embedded
The Agency × Integration model reveals the deeper structure beneath them.
✓ The important lesson is not to force every AI use case into one perfectly defined box.

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Thank you!
Have Fun!

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